

Questions on Informal Reports

Equipment evaluation

M&K has decided to make a bulk purchase of 20 personal computers. (For the purposes of this assignment, choose a computer that you are familiar with.) The machinery will go in a new department being set up in several months. Assume that M&K now uses five different types of PCs. In the interests of a fair comparison/ contrast, Mana Cesta, who manages the Toronto office, has asked you to evaluate the effectiveness of the system you use yourself. Several other employees are doing the same. Write a memo report that includes your evaluation. (Consult guidelines in the "For Equipment Evaluations" section of this chapter.) She will use the data and opinions in all the equipment evaluations she receives to make her choice for the bulk purchase.

Your criteria for evaluation might include topics such as one or more of the following:

- Physical design of the equipment
- Quality of the supplied documentation
- Frequency and cost of maintenance
- Availability of appropriate software
- Length of coverage of warranty
- Proximity to a service centre
- Reputation of the manufacturer

Equipment Evaluation

Assume that your university is preparing to buy small appliances to equip a kitchen in a new campus dormitory building. The purchasing office wants to know how appliances in the existing dormitory kitchens have performed. Choose a small appliance that you have access to, such as a toaster, microwave, or coffee maker, and evaluate its suitability for use in the shared kitchens. Your criteria for evaluation might include topics such as one or more of the following:

Physical design of the appliance	Ease with which appliance can be learned
Quality of the written instructions	Ease of cleaning and maintenance
Useful features	Length of coverage of warranty
Nearness to a service center	Reputation of the manufacturer

Progress Report

Assume that you have worked as a field hand at M-Global's Atlanta office for 15 years. Because of your reliability, good judgment, and intelligence, the company is paying for your enrollment at a local college. Also, you get half-time off, with pay. Because of its investment in you, M-Global expects you to report on your college work, after every six months. Following the guidelines in the "Progress Reports" section of the chapter, write a report on your recent course work (completed or ongoing classes or both). Direct the memo report to the manager of engineering, Wade Simkins. Organize the report by class, and then give specific updates on each one.

Activity Report

Assume that you have worked as a field hand at M-Global's Atlanta office for 15 years. Because of your reliability, good judgment, and intelligence, the company is paying for your enrollment at a local college. Also, you get half-time off, with pay. Because of its investment in you, M-Global expects you to report periodically on your college work. Following the guidelines in the "Periodic Reports", write a periodic report on your recent course work (completed or ongoing classes or both). Direct the memo report to the manager of engineering, Wade Simkins. Organize the report by class, and then give specific updates on each one.

Problem Analysis—Team Project

In your team, share information about any problems that team members have encountered with services or facilities at the college or university you attend. Then select a problem substantive enough to be described in a short report. As a team, write a problem analysis in the format described in this chapter. Select as your audience the appropriate administrators at the college or university.

Problem Analysis

As a landscape engineer for M-Global, one of your jobs is to examine problems associated with the design of walkways, the location of trees and garden beds etc. Assume that you have been hired by a specific college, community, or company with which you are familiar. Your objective is to evaluate one or more landscaping problems at the site. Write an informal report that describes the problem(s) in detail. Be specific about how the problem affects people—the employees, inhabitants, students, and so on. Following are some sample problems that could be evaluated:

Poorly landscaped entrance to a major subdivision

Muddy, unpaved walkway between dormitories and academic buildings on a college campus

Unpaved parking lot far from main campus buildings

Soil runoff into the streets from several steep, muddy subdivision lots that have not yet been sold

City tennis courts with poor drainage

Lack of adequate flowers or bushes around a new office building

Need for a landscaped common area within a subdivision or campus

Need to save some large trees that may be in danger because of proposed construction

Feasibility Report

Think of a project/ a business idea or the one you are working on in your report

- Follow the letter format
- Invent names or addresses where necessary.
- Invent any extra information you may need for the details of the report
- Your Report may follow the following structure:

Introductory Summary

Defining Your Idea

Detail about your product, service, company, app.

Market Analysis

All your primary and secondary survey data goes

Costs

Details about what it will cost to run your operation

Conclusions and Recommendations

So...is it feasible? Pull all your data together to answer the big question.